

Alpha prototype specification

Interaction contract for the research prototype; decisions are scoped to moderated usability sessions.

Handoff anchor	Beacon Field Research / Study Alpha / 2026-07-13 / session UX-184 / n=24
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Welcome	→	Project list	→	Search results	→	Study detail	→	Saved
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System model

The prototype supports a participant moving from Welcome to Project List, Search Results, Study Detail, and Saved Studies. The persistent state is the **Research context**: active query, applied filters, saved set, and last safe return route.

Screen	Purpose	Primary action
Welcome	Set expectations and resume a saved session.	Continue to Project List
Project List	Browse the default study index.	Open search or a study card
Search Results	Refine a query without losing context.	Apply filters or open detail
Study Detail	Inspect scope and eligibility.	Save, share, or return

State contract

Loading uses skeleton cards for up to 1.5 seconds. A delayed response replaces the skeleton with a retryable timeout state at 8 seconds. Empty results preserve the entered query and show one clear-reset action. Saving is optimistic; failure reverts the icon and announces the reason.

State	Visible treatment	Exit condition
Default	24 study cards, sort: Most relevant	Query, filter, or card selection
Filtered	Applied-filter count and removable chips	Remove chip, clear all, or modify
Empty	No matching studies; suggested reset	Clear filters or revise query
Offline save	Queued save badge; local confirmation	Reconnect then reconcile

Acceptance checks

Keyboard focus enters the main landmark after navigation. Back returns to the exact prior query, scroll offset, and filter state. No destructive action occurs on a single tap; removing a saved study provides Undo for 5 seconds.

Check	Pass criterion
Search persistence	A detail round trip preserves query, filters, sort, and scroll position.
Selection feedback	Saved state changes within 150 ms or explains queued/offline status.
Error recovery	Retry retains user input; reset is never the only available path.